

BIOSITE

IDEAS, SKETCHES, AND INSPIRATION

MODULE 5.2
SUBJECT Fabian
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INSTRUCTOR Sue Sampson
DATE September 2026

PROJECT OVERVIEW

This document collects the planning assets for the bioSite project: a three page website telling the story of Fabian, a twenty-one year old automotive technician, former Citadel cadet, and lifelong car enthusiast.

The site is built around a single idea, drawn from his own answers: **Fabian goes looking for things that carry consequence.** It is why he chose a military college over a normal one, why he prefers the complicated end of the repair order, and why he plays games that punish improvisation. The design direction, palette, and page structure all serve that thesis.

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DESIGN DIRECTION & RESEARCH

UNDERSTANDING THE SUBJECT

Research for this project covered three areas outside my own knowledge of Fabian. The Citadel is one of six senior military colleges recognized by Congress, where all cadets participate in ROTC and roughly a third of each graduating class commissions into the armed forces (The Citadel, n.d.). The certification ladder he is aiming at is administered by the National Institute for Automotive Service Excellence, a nonprofit third party founded in 1972 that credentials service professionals by examination (National Institute for Automotive Service Excellence, n.d.). The third area was the tactical realism subgenre of first person shooters. The interview then reframed all three.

What the interview made clear is that these are not three separate interests. He went to a military college because he knew a conventional environment would not hold him. He got into cars through a video game about assembling one from parts. He plays tactical realism games because ordinary shooters strip out consequence, and consequence is the thing he is actually after. The through line is not cars, and it is not the military. It is that he wants problems where the procedure matters and getting it wrong costs something.

VISUAL DIRECTION

The site borrows from the **technical spec sheet**: a motorsport pit board, a service manual, a data plate riveted to a door jamb. Dark backgrounds with a single high visibility accent, condensed uppercase headings, monospaced labels for anything that reads as data, and generous whitespace so the photography carries the page. This avoids two easy traps for a subject like this, namely the neon street racing cliché and heavy handed military imagery. The restraint is the point.

INSPIRATION SOURCES

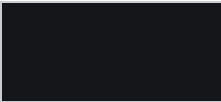
SOURCE	WHAT IT CONTRIBUTES
Motorsport pit signage	High contrast amber on near black; condensed type; number plates as graphic elements
Service manual layout	Labeled figures, monospaced captions, rigid grid, information density without clutter
Night automotive photography	Fabian's own car photos are night shots; the dark palette is drawn directly from his images rather than imposed on them
Military data plates	Uppercase letterspaced labels, thin rules, restrained color use

TONE OF VOICE

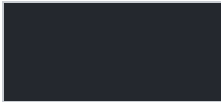
Plain and unsentimental. Short declarative sentences. The copy should sound like someone explaining what they do, not like a brand describing itself. No exclamation points, no superlatives about passion.

SELECTED COLOR PALETTE

Six colors, pulled from the subject's own photographs. The near blacks and pearl white come from his night shots of the project car. The amber is the high visibility accent found on pit crew equipment and shop signage, and it doubles as the accent tying to the Mustang.



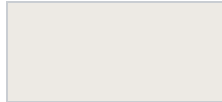
Ink
#14161A
Primary background, header, footer



Gunmetal
#24282E
Secondary surfaces, cards on dark, body text on light



Steel
#8B939C
Muted text, captions, borders, rules



Pearl
#EDEAE4
Light page background, text on dark



Amber
#F0B429
Accent: links, buttons, rules, active nav



Brick
#A62B1F
Sparing secondary accent, used once per page maximum

CONTRAST VERIFICATION

All text pairings meet WCAG AA at minimum, and every pairing carrying body copy clears the 7:1 threshold for AAA (World Wide Web Consortium, 2018). Amber is never used for body copy on a light background, only on Ink and as a border or fill.

PAIRING	RATIO	APPROVED USE
Pearl on Ink	15.09 : 1 (AAA)	Body copy on dark sections, nav labels
Amber on Ink	9.72 : 1 (AAA)	Headings, links, active state on dark
Gunmetal on Pearl	12.33 : 1 (AAA)	Body copy on light sections
Ink on Amber	9.72 : 1 (AAA)	Primary button label
Steel on Pearl	2.59 : 1 (fails)	Decorative rules and borders only, never text

PROPORTION

Roughly 60 percent Ink and Gunmetal, 30 percent Pearl, 10 percent Amber. Brick is effectively a spot color and appears at most once on any given page. Restricting the accent this severely is what keeps the amber reading as a signal rather than as decoration.



STYLE GUIDE: TYPOGRAPHY

TYPEFACES

ROLE	FAMILY	RATIONALE
Display / headings	Oswald (Google Fonts) weights 500, 700	Condensed grotesque. Reads like pit board and signage lettering. Set uppercase with letterspacing.
Body	Inter (Google Fonts) weights 400, 600	High legibility at small sizes, neutral, does not compete with the display face.
Data / labels	Roboto Mono (Google Fonts) weight 400	Used for captions, figure labels, nav, and buttons. Carries the spec sheet character.
Fallback stack	'Oswald', Impact, sans-serif 'Inter', Helvetica, Arial, sans-serif 'Roboto Mono', Consolas, monospace	

TYPE SCALE

Base size 16px, 1.25 modular scale, rem units throughout.

ELEMENT	SIZE	WEIGHT	LINE HEIGHT	LETTERSPACING	TRANSFORM
h1	3.05rem / 49px	700	1.05	0.02em	uppercase
h2	2.44rem / 39px	700	1.15	0.02em	uppercase
h3	1.56rem / 25px	500	1.25	0.04em	uppercase
body	1rem / 16px	400	1.65	normal	none
lead	1.25rem / 20px	400	1.55	normal	none
caption	0.8rem / 13px	400 mono	1.45	0.08em	uppercase
label	0.8rem / 13px	400 mono	1.2	0.14em	uppercase

MEASURE AND RHYTHM

Body copy is capped at 68 characters per line. Vertical rhythm uses an 8px base unit, so all margins and padding are multiples of 8. Paragraph spacing is 24px. Section padding is 96px top and bottom on desktop, 48px on mobile.

SPECIMEN

FABIAN

TECHNICIAN · CITADEL · BUILDER

He fixes what other people replace. The habit started young and turned into a trade,
and the trade turned into a way of looking at almost everything else.

FIG. 01 — HEADING, LABEL, AND LEAD PARAGRAPH IN COMBINATION

STYLE GUIDE: COMPONENTS

Organized by the Atomic Design methodology, in which atoms combine into molecules, molecules into organisms, and organisms into templates and pages (Frost, 2016). The three page templates in the following section are assembled entirely from the pieces below.

ATOMS — BUTTONS

VIEW THE BUILD

READ MORE

ON DARK

PADDING 12PX 28PX | RADIUS 0 | HOVER: AMBER FILL, INK LABEL, 120MS EASE

ATOMS — LINKS

Body text containing an inline link and an external link to The Citadel.

DEFAULT #14161A W/ 2PX AMBER UNDERLINE | HOVER: AMBER BACKGROUND FILL | VISITED #6B7178 | FOCUS: 2PX AMBER OUTLINE, 2PX OFFSET

MOLECULES — NAVIGATION

FABIAN HOME ABOUT HOBBIES

STICKY, 64PX TALL | ACTIVE PAGE MARKED WITH AMBER LABEL AND 2PX UNDERLINE | COLLAPSES TO STACKED LIST UNDER 768PX

MOLECULES — FIGURE WITH CAPTION

IMAGE

FIG. 03 — THE PROJECT CAR
One to two sentence caption explaining why this image belongs in the story. Captions are mandatory on every image in the build.

ORGANISMS — CONTENT CARD

HOBBY

THE BUILD

Short summary paragraph, three lines maximum, followed by a link into the detail section.

READ MORE

HOBBY

TACTICAL REALISM

Cards sit on a three column grid at desktop, two at tablet, one at mobile. Fixed height is not enforced.

READ MORE

LAYOUT TOKENS

TOKEN	VALUE	NOTES
Container max width	1200px	Centered, 24px side gutters
Grid	12 column, 24px gutter	Flexbox based; no framework
Spacing unit	8px	All spacing is a multiple
Breakpoints	1024px / 768px / 480px	Mobile first media queries
Border radius	0	Square corners throughout, no exceptions
Transition	120ms ease-out	Color and border only, never layout

WIREFRAME — LANDING PAGE

Purpose: establish who Fabian is in under five seconds, then present the three accomplishments that frame the rest of the site.

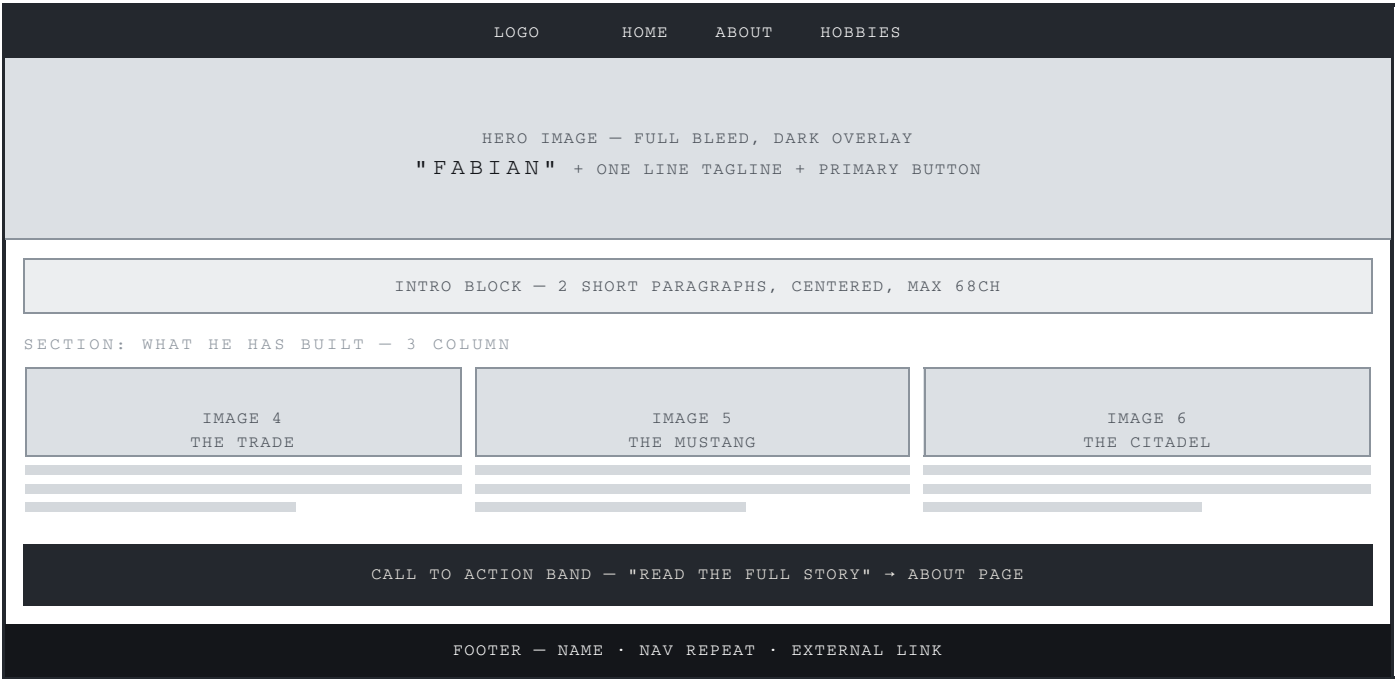


Fig. W1. Landing page, desktop. Sections stack to a single column below 768px; the three accomplishment columns become full width cards in the same order.

NOTES

The hero is the only place on the site where type sits over an image, and it uses a solid Ink overlay at 55 percent opacity so the tagline holds contrast. Everything below the hero runs on the 12 column grid. The three accomplishment blocks are the landing page images required by the assignment, each with its own short write-up rather than a bare caption.

WIREFRAME — ABOUT PAGE

Purpose: deliver the formal biography and the portrait. This is the page that carries the 250 word write-up and the external link.

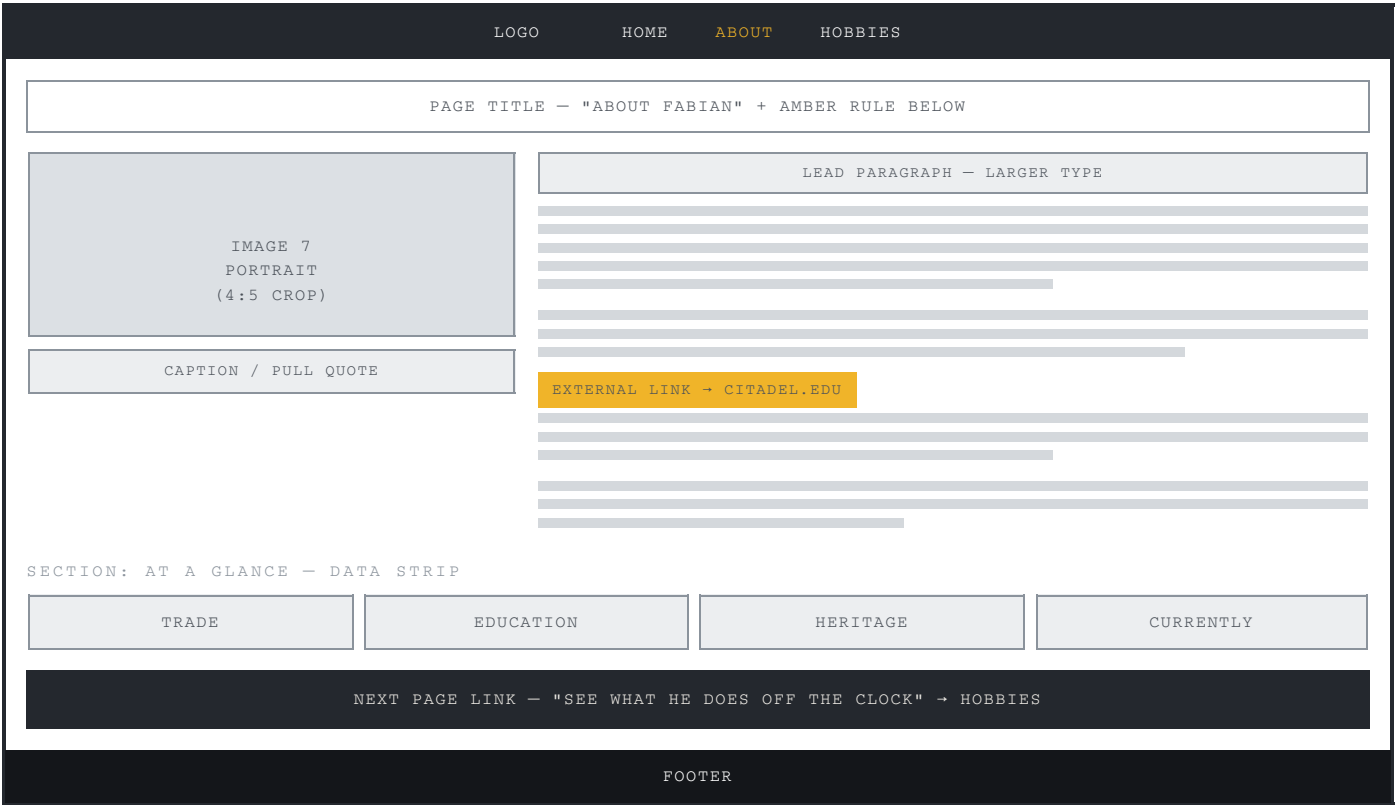


Fig. W2. About page, desktop. The portrait column collapses above the text at mobile widths, matching the assignment requirement that the portrait sit above the write-up.

NOTES

The data strip is a deliberate reference to a vehicle spec plate and reuses the monospaced label atom. It gives the page a second information layer without adding more prose. The external link is placed mid paragraph rather than in the footer so it reads as a genuine citation.

WIREFRAME — HOBBIES PAGE

Purpose: show the two threads that occupy his time away from work, and connect them back to the trait established on the landing page.



Fig. W3. Hobbies page, desktop. Alternating image and text blocks create a reading rhythm down the page; all blocks stack image first at mobile.

NOTES

The alternating layout does real work here. It slows the reader down and keeps each hobby visually separate, which matters because the two interests look unrelated at a glance. The closing band is where the copy makes the connection between them explicit.

INTERVIEW INSTRUMENT

Ten open ended questions administered to the subject. Questions were written after background research so that each one targets a specific area of his life rather than inviting a yes or no answer. Responses are recorded as given, with light copy editing for punctuation and spelling.

1. Tell me about The Citadel. Why did you go, what was the experience actually like, and where does it sit in your life now?

The Citadel is one of four senior military colleges across the country designed to teach military and civilian leadership skills alongside a typical four year degree. I decided to go because I knew myself and that I am not built for a typical academic or work environment. I had gone with the intention of earning a Reserve Officer Training Corps (ROTC) scholarship in my first year. The experience itself was difficult, but the most rewarding thing I have ever done in my life. For nine months I was pushed beyond my limits and forced to re-discover the meaning of a busy day. I had to balance Civil Engineering classes with Infantry Platoon Leader Courses and the additional Ranger training I volunteered for. During the summer between my freshman year and sophomore year, while preparing to return as a Cadre Corporal, I received notice that I was not to return due to a fight I had gotten into with another cadet. In my life today it serves as a reminder that I can do things most people would never consider doing, while simultaneously serving as a lesson in learning how to conduct myself to a higher standard for the sake of my career.

2. How did you get into working on cars, and what made you decide to do it as a career instead of keeping it a hobby?

I originally got into working on cars by playing video games. I once stumbled across a game called My Summer Car, and it introduced me to the challenging yet rewarding job of working on cars. When I moved back to California from college I needed a job and at the time I had very little skills that would transfer into the civilian sector. I worked at an auto parts store, where I bought myself a five hundred dollar car from a junkyard and learned to work on it. Eventually I decided that while I prepared to become a police officer, I would do what I figured I was naturally good at to make a living.

3. Walk me through a normal day at the shop. What kind of work comes across your bay, and what part do you actually enjoy?

I typically arrive at the shop fifteen to twenty minutes early so I can change into my work clothes, grab some water and use the bathroom if needed. I will then head into what we call the pit, where I will be underneath the cars without having to lift them, allowing me to do my work faster. My typical work includes oil changes, transmission services, differential services, lifting cars for tire rotations and inspecting the underside of the vehicle for any damages to be noted. I enjoy doing the advanced services, meaning transmissions, European cars, and modifications, because that is when I can just focus on my work without other people constantly checking in on my progress.

4. What is the hardest repair or diagnosis you have pulled off, and what did it take to figure it out?

The hardest repair I have done was actually at the last shop I worked at. There we had a Honda come in with half the car dented inward. It sat for a week before insurance let us work on it, where we then had to strip the car, cut a quarter of it off and weld the frame back together with a new one from the factory. I did that as an apprentice and was constantly having to ask my journeymen and look things up on Alldata and YouTube.

5. Tell me about the project car. What is it, what condition was it in when you got it, and what have you done to it so far?

My project car is the car I bought when I moved back home from college. It is a 2004 Honda Civic EX. When I bought it, it had a blown head and we had to fix it and replace the valve cover. As for what I have done with it, it is the car I mess around on. I pulled the back seats out and replaced the suspension with race suspension. Then I added a cold air intake, replaced the gears in the transmission with rally gears, meaning a shorter ratio to make acceleration faster, and lastly painted the rear bumper and a rim white.

6. What is the end goal with that build, and what is the next thing on the list?

The end goal with the build is to create a monster of a car and take it to the track to compete with it. The next things I have planned are an ECU (Engine Control Unit) swap to be able to tune the car, as the stock ECU is locked by Honda. This will let me start doing further work on the car such as bigger fuel injectors, a turbo or headers.

7. What pulled you toward milsim and tactical realism games instead of standard shooters?

I got into milsim and realism games from my dad. My dad was a veteran and always talking about his time in Iraq, and as I got into video games I was always comparing what was shown to what I had heard. Since I was thirteen I was also a Police Explorer, so I have always been surrounded by the realities of being in a profession of arms. Regular shooters always had the fear aspect lacking. Nobody in those games cares about consequences, which eliminates a core aspect of the adrenaline rush I look for when I play video games.

8. What do you get out of that kind of gaming that you do not get anywhere else? Do you run with a regular group?

The adrenaline rush during the gameplay is the main thing. When I did military or law enforcement training, the adrenaline rush of perceived combat, basically as real as you could get, was unmatched. I loved that rush and it is somewhat addicting. With milsim games I can experience the same rush, sometimes even greater, and there is no risk of harm to myself. I play with my best friend Kristian when our schedules align, but outside of that I typically play with whoever I can meet that evening.

9. Where do you want the mechanic career to go over the next five years — certifications, a specialty, your own shop?

Within the next five years I want to look at getting my ASE certifications in engine and transmission work, as that will make me highly marketable to dealerships which pay much higher and offer real shop space to work. I would hope to get into a shop I have been building a relationship with for the past year that specializes in high end GT3 and GT2 Porsche cars.

10. If somebody only knew one thing about you, what would you want it to be?

If someone knew only one thing about me, I would want it to be that no matter how bad it gets, I am ride or die for mine.

SUBJECT BIOGRAPHY

360 WORDS

Fabian is twenty-one years old and works as an automotive technician. He is Greek and Mexican, and the path that got him under a car is not the one anyone would guess.

It started with The Citadel, one of six senior military colleges recognized by Congress (The Citadel, n.d.). He chose it deliberately, knowing he was not built for a conventional academic environment, and he went in aiming at an ROTC scholarship. For nine months he balanced Civil Engineering coursework with Infantry Platoon Leader Courses and Ranger training he volunteered for on top of everything else. He describes it as the hardest and most rewarding thing he has done, and it left him with a working standard he still measures himself against.

The cars came from a video game. He found My Summer Car, a simulator built around assembling a vehicle from parts, and it showed him a kind of problem he liked. Back in California he took a job at an auto parts store, bought a five hundred dollar car out of a junkyard, and taught himself on it. The trade followed from there. Today his day runs on oil changes, transmission and differential services, and inspections, and the work he actually wants is the complicated end of it: transmissions, European cars, modifications. As an apprentice he helped cut a wrecked Honda apart and weld a factory frame section back into it, asking journeymen and chasing procedures the whole way through.

His own car is a 2004 Honda Civic EX that arrived with a blown head. It now has race suspension, rally gears, a cold air intake, and no back seats. The goal is the track. Next is an ECU swap, because Honda locks the factory one and nothing else can happen until it is open.

Away from the shop he plays tactical realism games, an interest that traces back to his father, a veteran, and to seven years as a Police Explorer starting at thirteen. Ordinary shooters do not work for him because nothing in them carries consequence.

In five years he wants ASE certifications in engine and transmission work, and a bay at a shop that builds GT3 and GT2 Porsches.

IMAGE INVENTORY

Seven images, all photographed by the subject or the author. Three support the Hobbies page, three support the Landing page, and one portrait anchors the About page. License plates have been blurred and third party faces redacted.

HOBBIES — HOBBIES PAGE



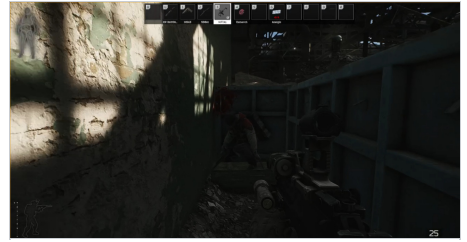
IMG 01 — THE PROJECT CAR

The 2004 Honda Civic EX. It came to him with a blown head and has since taken race suspension, rally gears, and a cold air intake, with the rear seats pulled out. It opens the Hobbies page because the build is the hobby, and because a car bought broken and fixed in stages is the clearest picture of how he spends his own time.



IMG 02 — TWO CARS, ONE CURB

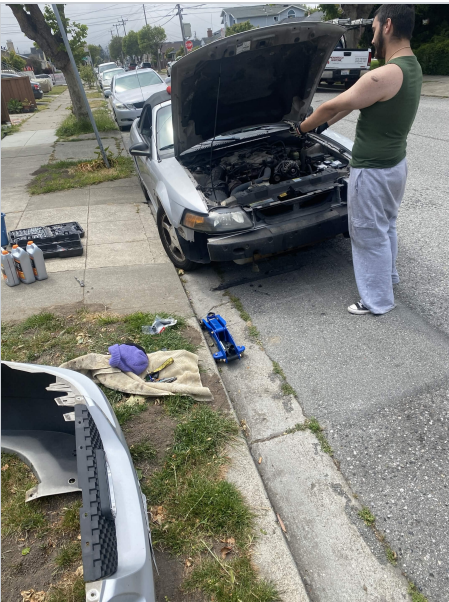
His Civic at right, the author's Mustang at left, both stripped down on a Saturday afternoon. It shows the build mid-progress rather than finished, and it makes the point that the work is something he does alongside people rather than alone in a garage.



IMG 03 — TACTICAL REALISM

His own gameplay capture. He plays this genre because ordinary shooters remove consequence, and consequence is the thing he is after. That is the same reason he wants the difficult end of the repair order, so this image is what ties the two halves of the Hobbies page together.

GOALS AND ACCOMPLISHMENTS — LANDING PAGE



IMG 04 — THE TRADE

Fabian doing paid diagnostic work on a customer vehicle, front end stripped and parts laid out on the sidewalk. It belongs on the landing page because it shows the trade being practiced rather than described, and because the career is the thread the rest of the story hangs on.



IMG 05 — THE MUSTANG

His 2015 Mustang EcoBoost Premium with the 50 Years Appearance Package, bought outright with money he saved. The accomplishment here is the buying, not the car, which is why the image sits beside the work photograph rather than on the Hobbies page.



IMG 06 — THE CITADEL

Fabian in cadet uniform, far right; the other three cadets are redacted because they did not consent to appear. He calls his nine months there the hardest and most rewarding thing he has done, and it is where the standard he still measures himself against came from.

PORTRAIT — ABOUT PAGE



IMG 07 — PORTRAIT

Current photograph of the subject, taken for this project. It sits above the biography on the About page, cropped to 4:5 so the frame tightens and the busy background falls away.



SUPPLEMENTARY — 50 YEARS BADGE

Shot and edited by Fabian himself, reserved for the landing page hero behind the dark overlay. It earns its place because it is his own photographic work rather than a photograph of his possessions, and the shallow depth of field suits a full bleed treatment.

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PRIMARY SOURCE

Fabian. (2026, September). *Personal interview*. Conducted by K. Wareing. Full transcript reproduced on page 9 of this document.